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Ph.D. Program in Electronics, Computer Science and Electrical Engineering

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Secure someone else's computer: A hands-on Cloud Security demo

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May 12, 2026 - h. 11:00

Magenta Seminar Room, D Floor

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Abstract:

The cloud has become the substrate of modern software — yet most engineers learn to build on it long before they learn to secure it. In the rush to migrate everything online, the same mistakes repeat themselves: misconfigurations, overly permissive identities, forgotten resources, and security bolted on after the fact. From the foundations of cloud computing to its most common security failures, the path is traced through live demonstrations: building a virtual machine from scratch, tracing how machines can become the entry point of a real-world breach, and exploring how modern Cloud-Native Application Protection Platforms (CNAPPs) make sense of the toxic combinations of small misconfigurations that turn into critical risks. Across these demonstrations, one idea is reinforced: security must be considered from the outset, not introduced after the fact. The closing discussion turns this principle — security by design — into a habit of mind that separates the engineers who anticipate failure from those who only respond to it.

Biographies:

Andrea Galmuzzi is a Consultant at Spike Reply, where he advises clients on the design and security of cloud-native environments across AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud. His work spans cloud security posture management, cloud workload protection, and the operational use of CNAPP platforms to surface, prioritize, and remediate real-world cloud risk. Andrea holds a Master Degree in Computer Engineering from the University of Pavia.

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